

013. Chapter 2 Verses 32-38

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.32

यदृच्छया चोपपन्नं स्वर्गद्वारमपावृतम् ।
सुखिनः क्षत्रियाः पार्थ लभन्ते युद्धमीदृशम् ॥ 32 ॥

*yadṛichchayā chopapannaṁ swarga-dvāram apāvṛitam
sukhinaḥ kṣatriyāḥ pārtha labhante yuddham īdṛiṣham*

yadṛichchayā—unsought; cha—and; upapannam—come; swarga—celestial abodes; dvāram—door; apāvṛitam—wide open; sukhinaḥ—happy; kṣatriyāḥ—warriors; pārtha—Arjun, the son of Pritha; labhante—obtain; yuddham—war; īdṛiṣham—such

Happy indeed are the kshatriyas, O Pārtha, to whom comes such a war, offering itself unsought, opening the gate to heaven.

VERSE 2.33

अथ चेतत्त्वमिमं धर्म्यं संग्रामं न करिष्यसि ।
ततः स्वधर्मं कीर्तिं च हित्वा पापमवाप्स्यसि ॥ 33 ॥

*atha chet tvam imam dharmyam saṅgrāmaṁ na kariṣhyasi
tataḥ sva-dharmam kīrtim cha hitvā pāpam avāpsyasi*

atha chet—if, however; tvam—you; imam—this; dharmyam saṅgrāmaṁ—righteous war; na—not; kariṣhyasi—act; tataḥ—then; sva-dharmam—one’s duty in accordance with the Vedas; kīrtim—reputation; cha—and; hitvā—abandoning; pāpam—sin; avāpsyasi—will incur

But if you do not fight this righteous war you would incur sin by abandoning your own duty, name, and fame.

अकीर्तिं चापि भूतानि
कथयिष्यन्ति तेऽव्ययाम् ।
सम्भावितस्य चाकीर्ति
मरणादतिरिच्यते ॥ 34 ॥

*akīrtiṁ chāpi bhūtāni
kathayiṣhyanti te 'vyayām
sambhāvitasya chākīrtir
maraṇād atirichyate*

akīrtim—infamy; **cha**—and; **api**—also; **bhūtāni**—people; **kathayiṣhyanti**—will speak; **te**—of your; **avyayām**—everlasting; **sambhāvitasya**—of a respectable person; **cha**—and; **akīrtiḥ**—infamy; **marañāt**—than death; **atirichyate**—is greater

And also, these people will speak of your everlasting dishonor, and to one who is honored, dishonor is worse than death.

भयाद्रणादुपरतं मंस्यन्ते त्वां महारथाः ।
येषां च त्वं बहुमतो भूत्वा यास्यसि लाघवम् ॥ 35 ॥

*bhayād raṇād uparatam mansyante tvāṁ mahā-rathāḥ
yeṣhām cha tvam bahu-mato bhūtvā yāsyasi lāghavam*

bhayāt—out of fear; **raṇāt**—from the battlefield; **uparatam**—have fled; **manṣyante**—will think; **tvām**—you; **mahā-rathāḥ**—warriors who could single handedly match the strength of ten thousand ordinary warriors; **yeṣhām**—for whom; **cha**—and; **tvam**—you; **bahu-mataḥ**—high esteemed; **bhūtvā**—having been; **yāsyasi**—you will loose; **lāghavam**—decreased in value

Moreover, those great warriors from whom you received honor formerly would think that you turned away from battle out of fear, and regard you with little respect hereafter.

अवाच्यवादांश्च बहून्वदिष्यन्ति तवाहिताः ।
निन्दन्तस्तव सामर्थ्यं ततो दुःखतरं नु किम् ॥ 36 ॥

*avāchya-vādānś cha bahūn vadiṣhyanti tavāhitāḥ
nindantastava sāmārthyam tato duḥkhataram nu kim*

avāchya-vādān—using harsh words; cha—and; bahūn—many; vadiṣhyanti—will say; tava—your; ahitāḥ—enemies; nindantaḥ—defame; tava—your; sāmārthyam—might; tataḥ—than that; duḥkha-taram—more painful; nu—indeed; kim—what

Your enemies belittle your ability, and in various ways speak words of ill-fame and shame about you. What is there more painful than this?

हतो वा प्राप्स्यसि स्वर्गं जित्वा वा भोक्ष्यसे महीम् ।
तस्मादुत्तिष्ठ कौन्तेय युद्धाय कृतनिश्चयः ॥ 37 ॥

*hato vā prāpsyasi swargam jitvā vā bhokṣhyase mahīm
tasmād uttiṣṭha kaunteya yuddhāya kṛita-niśchayaḥ*

hataḥ—slain; vā—or; prāpsyasi—you will attain; swargam—celestial abodes; jitvā—by achieving victory; vā—or; bhokṣhyase—you shall enjoy; mahīm—the kingdom on earth; tasmāt—therefore; uttiṣṭha—arise; kaunteya—Arjun, the son of Kunti; yuddhāya—for fight; kṛita-niśchayaḥ—with determination

If you are killed in the battle, you will go to heaven; if you win, you will enjoy the earth. Therefore arise, O son of Kunti, resolved to fight.

सुखदुःखे समे कृत्वा लाभालाभौ जयाजयौ ।
ततो युद्धाय युज्यस्व नैवं पापमवाप्स्यसि ॥ ३८ ॥

sukha-duḥkhe same kṛtvā lābhālābhau jayājayau
tato yuddhāya yujyasva naivaṁ pāpam avāpsyasi

sukha—happiness; **duḥkhe**—in distress; **same kṛtvā**—treating alike; **lābha-alābhau**—gain and loss; **jaya-ajayau**—victory and defeat; **tataḥ**—thereafter; **yuddhāya**—for fighting; **yujyasva**—engage; **na**—never; **evam**—thus; **pāpam**—sin; **avāpsyasi**—shall incur

Having an equal mind in pain and pleasure, gain and loss, victory and defeat, engage in battle and thereby you will not incur sin.